

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



Jerry Moore, 86, looks at the Purple Heart that belonged to his late brother, World War II veteran John L. Moore, alongside John's granddaughter Angie Holliger. The state treasurer's office, which handles unclaimed property, returned the medal Wednesday. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Purple Heart returned to family of Peoria veteran

Medal one of many rescued from the state's unclaimed property vaults

By Christy Gutowski
Chicago Tribune

DECATUR — Nearly 81 years to the date after 20-year-old Army Pfc. John L. Moore was wounded while fighting to liberate Europe during WWII, the Purple Heart he earned that day is now in the hands of his only surviving sibling.

Jerry Moore was little more than a toddler when his brother went off to war.

Now 86, Moore held the heart-shaped medal for what he said

was the first time after Illinois Treasurer Michael Frerichs presented it to him Wednesday at the World War II memorial in Decatur. The poignant ceremony, which included the Macon County Honor Guard, was held just days before the Independence Day holiday weekend.

"It means a lot to my heart," said Jerry Moore, fighting back tears. "I don't think there can be any higher honor than getting this back."

The Decatur man was joined by

several family members, including a granddaughter of his late brother, who died in 2002. Angie Holliger flew in from Colorado for the occasion.

"My grandpa would be so happy about this and that it is back with our family," she said.

Frerichs launched "Operation Purple Heart" in late 2021 to raise awareness about war medals that had ended up in the state's unclaimed property section after they were left in abandoned safe deposit boxes at banks.

The state treasurer has returned 15 Purple Hearts, including Moore's, during his three terms in office.

Last winter, the Tribune wrote about its own efforts to identify the veterans who had earned the Purple Hearts that at the time remained unclaimed. After months of researching public records, unearthing decades-old war documents and interviewing people linked to the safe

Turn to Heart, Page 6

Family of slain officer seeks answers as civil probe is announced

By Caroline Kubzansky and Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

The family of slain Chicago police Officer Krystal Rivera is calling for city agencies to relinquish the investigation of her death and, instead, turn over the probe to the Illinois State Police as they pursue legal avenues.

The slain officer's parents and their attorney also asked that the city release the body-worn camera footage that captured the fatal June 5 shooting — despite a standing order from a Cook County judge preventing the public release.

Rivera's mother Yolanda and stepfather Rico Thompson, flanked by friends, family and staff at a news conference

Wednesday afternoon, said her mother needed to understand what happened June 5 to make Rivera the first CPD officer to die of friendly fire in nearly 40 years.

"I need to understand what happened that night," Yolanda Rivera said. "I need to know the truth. Krystal believed in protecting and serving with honor. Please honor her. Let this moment be guided by truth."

Her stepfather echoed that thought, asking city leaders to be open.

"We are here asking both Mayor (Brandon) Johnson and Superintendent (Larry) Snelling for full transparency," Thompson said. "We as a family need

Turn to Officer, Page 4



JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Stocking up for the holiday

Kyle Koehne, of Posen, with his wife, Amanda, and their daughter, Kali, 1, buy fireworks at Krazy Kaplans Fireworks in Hammond, Indiana, on Wednesday. Many residents of Illinois are flocking across the border to Indiana to buy their fireworks for the Fourth of July holiday. **Story on Page 3**

County's troubled computer overhaul boils over, as leaders point fingers

Delayed Cook tax bills could go out even later

By A.D. Quig
Chicago Tribune

Cook County property tax bills already on track to be at least one month tardy may arrive even later as controversial contractor Tyler

Technologies' upgrades to the countywide property tax systems are again running behind schedule, leading to mounting frustration and political fighting among county leaders.

Cook County Board President Toni Preckwinkle's office on Wednesday published the first of what is expected to be several reports detailing the technology

delays and assigning blame for whether the fault lies with Tyler or with Assessor Fritz Kaegi, Treasurer Maria Pappas or Clerk Monica Gordon, the three county officeholders who handle property taxes.

Underscoring just how many problems remain to be fixed, the report noted the expected due dates for 105 issues that need to

be resolved for the new computer system to be fully operational are still "TBD."

Though it negotiated the original Tyler contract — which has been criticized for not initially holding Tyler accountable for repeated delays and missing numerous deadlines — Preckwinkle's office in a statement pointed the finger at Tyler and the three other county

offices for the problems. The county's Bureau of Technology, which is overseen by Preckwinkle and has generally coordinated with the property tax offices over the years, does not have any listed responsibilities in the report.

In the statement, Preckwinkle's office said it will continue to

Turn to County, Page 4

TODAY'S WEATHER



High **91** Low **73**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 18

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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